

INDEPENDENT PORTFOLIO PROJECT

LaunchReady

SaaS Implementation & Onboarding Case Study

Discovery → Requirements → Planning → Data → UAT → Enablement → Go-Live → Measurement

Prepared by	Role demonstrated	Scenario
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PORTFOLIO DISCLOSURE

This is an independent simulated SaaS implementation. Northstar Community Services, LaunchReady, all data, metrics, stakeholders, defects, and results are fictional. This work does not represent a real customer, employer, production deployment, revenue claim, or verified business outcome.

Executive Summary

Northstar Community Services is a fictional 475-employee, eight-location organization whose onboarding process relied on spreadsheets, email, PDFs, and separate departmental checklists. LaunchReady demonstrates how an implementation analyst could move that customer through a controlled two-location SaaS pilot while preserving requirements, data quality, test evidence, launch governance, and measurable adoption.

Central project decision

Prioritize centralized status tracking because the lack of a single source of truth drives manual follow-up, missed dependencies, inconsistent first-day readiness, and weak reporting.

Project choice	Decision
Request owner	Hiring managers submit standardized onboarding requests
Rollout	Two-location pilot, then expansion to six remaining locations
Primary goal	Centralized status and task ownership
Success lens	Speed, accuracy, compliance, reduced manual work, and adoption
Tooling	Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint, and an Excel-based implementation dashboard

Role demonstrated

- Facilitate discovery and translate findings into requirements.
- Coordinate timeline, stakeholders, risks, decisions, and dependencies.
- Prepare, map, clean, and validate sample customer data.
- Design UAT, track defects, and apply launch exit criteria.
- Develop onboarding, training, launch communication, and admin handoff.
- Measure simulated adoption and recommend Phase 2 improvements.

1. Customer and Product

Fictional customer: Northstar Community Services

Northstar supports community, workforce-development, and family-assistance programs. Approximately 25–35 employees join each month across eight locations. Growth has exposed inconsistencies in how requests are submitted, tasks are assigned, documents are retained, and status is reported.

Fictional product: LaunchReady Employee Operations Platform

- Digital onboarding requests with required-field validation
- Configurable task and approval workflows
- Role- and location-based checklists
- Equipment and access requests
- Automated reminders and escalations
- Role-based permissions and audit history
- CSV data import, dashboards, and reporting
- Knowledge-base and guided onboarding content

In scope	Out of scope
Two-location pilot; onboarding intake; task routing; data import; UAT; role-based training; dashboards; hypercare	Payroll calculation; benefits enrollment; HRIS API integration; mobile application; organization-wide rollout

2. Problem and Current State

The core business problem is not simply “too many spreadsheets.” The larger issue is that no system owns the end-to-end onboarding record. Each function maintains a partial view, causing delays and repeated status requests.

Process area	Current-state failure	Business impact
Request intake	Required fields are frequently missing	Rework and delayed task start
Task assignment	Tasks are distributed through email	Unclear ownership and deadlines
Data	Eight spreadsheet formats are used	Duplicates and inconsistent values
Status	No central view exists	Manual follow-up and weak visibility
Communication	Employees receive inconsistent messages	Uneven onboarding experience
Compliance	Evidence is stored across inboxes and folders	Audit risk
Reporting	Metrics require manual compilation	Limited operational insight

Current-state workflow

1. Hiring manager emails HR with new-hire details.
2. HR re-enters information into a location spreadsheet.
3. HR sends separate requests to IT, facilities, payroll, and compliance.
4. Departments track tasks independently.
5. HR follows up through email and manually confirms completion.
6. Leadership receives inconsistent or delayed reporting.

3. Discovery and Requirements

Discovery was structured around goals, users, workflow variation, data, access, testing, training, launch, support, and measurement. The detailed question-and-finding register is included in the implementation workbook.

Finding	Requirement response
Central tracking is the highest priority	Create one onboarding record and shared status dashboard
Incomplete intake delays work	Block submission until required fields are valid
Tasks vary by role and location	Generate a mapped checklist automatically
IT is often notified late	Create IT tasks immediately after valid submission
Managers need limited visibility	Use least-privilege direct-report access
Data quality problems are expected	Reject invalid rows with field-level reasons
Compliance needs evidence	Retain timestamped audit history
Rollout risk is material	Use a two-location pilot and formal go/no-go review

Requirement categories

The approved scope contains business, functional, data, reporting, security, training, and nonfunctional requirements. Every requirement has an identifier, owner, priority, design response, UAT evidence, and delivery status.

ID	Requirement	Priority
BR-01	Provide one source of truth for onboarding status	Must
FR-01	Managers submit a standardized required-field request	Must
FR-02	Tasks are assigned by employee role and location	Must
DR-02	Invalid and duplicate rows are rejected before import	Must
RR-01	Dashboard displays completion, overdue work, and cycle time	Must
SR-01	Role-based least-privilege permissions are applied	Must
TR-01	Admin and manager training occurs before launch	Must

4. Future-State Design

The future state replaces fragmented coordination with validated intake, automatic task creation, centralized progress, exception-based management, and measurable results.

1. Manager submits a standardized request.
2. The platform validates required fields before accepting it.
3. A single onboarding record is created.
4. Role- and location-specific tasks are assigned automatically.
5. Owners receive reminders and overdue escalations.
6. Managers and HR monitor authorized records from dashboards.
7. HR manages exceptions instead of manually chasing every task.
8. Completion, adoption, cycle time, and overdue work are measured.

Workflow principle

Standardize the common path while using configuration rules for legitimate role and location differences. Exceptions are visible and auditable rather than managed in private email threads.

Key configuration rules

Configuration	Rule
Intake	Employee ID, name, email, start date, manager, role, and location are required
Task generation	Checklist is determined by role + location mapping
Reminders	Three days and one day before due date
Escalation	One day overdue to the task owner's manager
Permissions	Managers see direct reports; contributors edit assigned tasks
Audit	User, timestamp, previous value, and new value are retained

5. Implementation Plan and Governance

The pilot is organized as an eight-week implementation with explicit dependencies and an additional 10-business-day hypercare period.

Phase	Weeks	Exit evidence
Discovery	1	Validated current state and stakeholder findings
Requirements	2	Approved BRD, stories, and acceptance criteria
Design & Data	3-4	Configuration design and validated import file
Configuration	4-5	Configured workflows, roles, notifications, dashboards
Testing	5-6	System test, UAT, defect disposition, sign-off
Enablement	6-7	Admin and manager training completed
Launch	7	Readiness review and pilot go-live
Hypercare & Review	8+	Issue closeout and 30-day measurement

Governance

- Weekly written implementation status report with accomplishments, next steps, decisions, risks, and help needed.
- RACI clarifies accountable and responsible owners.
- RAID log tracks risk, assumption, issue, and dependency treatment.
- Decision log preserves date, rationale, status, and approver.
- Traceability matrix connects approved requirements to configuration and test evidence.

6. Data Readiness

The simulated import exercise contains realistic data-quality errors so the portfolio demonstrates analysis rather than presenting a perfect dataset. The full import template, mapping, exception reasons, corrections, and status appear in the workbook.

Error type	Example	Validation response
Invalid email	Missing @ symbol	Reject row and identify email field
Missing required value	Blank start date	Reject until owner supplies date
Invalid reference	Location value "Buffalo" instead of LOC-BUF	Map approved alias or reject
Duplicate key	Employee ID appears twice	Apply documented survivorship rule
Broken relationship	Manager ID is blank	Require valid manager reference
Nonstandard date	11/03/26	Normalize to YYYY-MM-DD

Data Import, Mapping & Validation											
Sample records intentionally include errors; corrected values demonstrate the validation workflow.											
	Employee ID	First Name	Last Name	Email	Start Date	Location Code	Manager ID	Role	Validation Error	Correction	Final Status
5	E1001	Amina	Rahman	amina.rahman@northstar.org	2026-10-26	LOC-BUF	M202	Care Coordinator	Valid		Ready
6	E1002	Daniel	Kim	daniel.kim@northstar.org	2026-10-27	LOC-BUF	M202	Analyst	Invalid email	daniel.kim@northstar.org	Corrected
7	E1003	Sofia	Lopez	sofia.lopez@northstar.org		LOC-ROC	M310	Program Assistant	Missing start date	2026-10-28	Corrected
8	E1004	Omar	Haddad	omar.haddad@northstar.org	2026-10-29	Buffalo	M202	IT Support	Invalid location code	LOC-BUF	Corrected
9	E1004	Omar	Haddad	omar.h@northstar.org	2026-10-29	LOC-BUF	M202	IT Support	Duplicate employee ID	Remove duplicate row	Corrected
10	E1006	Mel	Chen	mel.chen@northstar.org	2026-11-02	LOC-ROC		Case Manager	Missing manager ID	M310	Corrected
11	E1007	Noah	Williams	noah.williams@northstar.org	11/03/26	LOC-BUF	M202	Facilities Associate	Nonstandard date	2026-11-03	Corrected
12	E1008	Layla	Saleh	layla.saleh@northstar.org	2026-11-04	LOC-ROC	M310	Compliance Specialist	Valid		Ready
13											
14											
15	Source field	Target field	Data type	Required	Transformation rule	Owner					
16	employee_id	Employee ID	Text	Yes	Unique; trim spaces	HRIS					
17	work_email	Email	Text	Yes	Lowercase; valid email	HRIS					
18	hire_date	Start Date	Date	Yes	Convert to YYYY-MM-DD	HRIS					
19	site	Location Code	Text	Yes	Map approved aliases	HRIS Ops					
20	supervisor_id	Manager ID	Text	Yes	Must exist in manager	HRIS					
21	job_title	Role	Text	Yes	Map to approved role	HRIS Ops					

Workbook evidence: sample import records, intentional errors, corrections, and mapping rules.

7. UAT and Defect Management

UAT validates complete business scenarios rather than individual fields in isolation. Testers represent managers, HR administrators, data owners, compliance, IT, and executives.

Exit criterion	Threshold	Simulated evidence
Critical scenarios executed	100%	15 of 15 executed
Overall pass rate	At least 90%	14 of 15 passed after one retest
Critical/high defects	Zero open	Zero open
Medium defects	Mitigated and accepted	One workaround documented
Business approval	HR, IT, compliance	Recorded in go/no-go decision

Representative defects

ID	Severity	Finding	Disposition
DEF-01	High	Escalation routed to HR instead of manager	Rule corrected and TC-05 passed on retest
DEF-02	Medium	Cancelled request leaves one facilities task open	Admin workaround accepted; Phase 2 fix
DEF-03	Low	Dashboard export filename lacks date	Added to backlog; does not block pilot

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K
1	UAT Strategy, Test Results & Defect Tracker										
2	Exit criteria: 100% critical scenarios executed; no open critical/high defects; at least 90% overall pass rate.										
3											
4	Test ID	Scenario	Role	Expected result	Result	Requirement	Defect				
5	TC-01	Submit valid onboarding request	Manager	Request created; required fields saved	Pass	FR-01					
6	TC-02	Attempt submission with missing manager	Manager	Submission blocked; manager field identified	Pass	FR-01					
7	TC-03	Generate tasks for role/location	HR Admin	Correct checklist and owners created	Pass	FR-02					
8	TC-04	Send scheduled reminders	Task Owner	One reminder at each configured interval	Pass	FR-03					
9	TC-05	Escalate overdue task	HR Admin	Manager receives escalation after 1 day	Pass after retest	FR-04	DEF-01				
10	TC-06	Manager views direct reports	Manager	Only assigned direct reports visible	Pass	FR-05/SR-01					
11	TC-07	Attempt unauthorized employee access	Manager	Access denied and event logged	Pass	SR-01					
12	TC-08	Reconcile dashboard metrics	Executive	Metrics match source records	Pass	RR-01					
13	TC-09	Import valid CSV	Data Lead	All valid records loaded once	Pass	DR-01					
14	TC-10	Import invalid CSV	Data Lead	Invalid rows rejected with reasons	Pass	DR-02					
15	TC-11	Review audit history	Compliance	All tracked changes retain history	Pass	SR-02					
16	TC-12	Complete training scenario	Manager	User completes request without assistance	Pass	TR-01					
17	TC-13	Pilot page response	IT	Core pages load within 3 seconds	Pass	NR-01					
18	TC-14	Chrome and Edge checks	IT	Core functions work in both browsers	Pass	NR-02					
19	TC-15	Cancel onboarding request	HR Admin	Open tasks cancelled; history retained	Fail / workaround	FR-02	DEF-02				
20											
21											
22	Defect ID	Description	Severity	Status	Resolution / mitigation	Evidence					
23	DEF-01	Escalation routed to HR instead of manager	High	Closed	CFG-04 corrected	Retested TC-05					
24	DEF-02	Cancelled request leaves one facilities task open	Low	Mitigated	Documented admin workaround	Accepted for pilot					
25	DEF-03	Dashboard export filename lacks date	Low	Open	Backlog	Does not block launch					

Workbook evidence: UAT strategy, test results, requirement links, and defect dispositions.

8. Enablement and Customer Handoff

Enablement is role-based so each audience learns the decisions and actions relevant to its work. Written guides and recordings reduce reliance on recurring meetings.

Audience	Format	Core outcome
HR administrators	90-minute session + recording	Manage exceptions, reports, permissions, and audit evidence
Hiring managers	45-minute session + quick guide	Submit complete requests and monitor status
Task owners	30-minute demonstration	Complete assigned work and respond to reminders
Executives	20-minute briefing	Interpret adoption and performance metrics
New employees	Automated welcome guide	Complete forms and view assigned steps

Quick-reference: submit a request

1. Open New Hire > Create Request.
2. Complete employee, role, manager, location, start date, and email.
3. Review the generated checklist for accuracy.
4. Submit and monitor the status dashboard.
5. Use the support link for access or workflow exceptions.

Admin handoff contents

- Configuration inventory and owners
- Permission and user-provisioning procedure
- Data dictionary and import rules
- Known defects and accepted workarounds
- Support routing and escalation thresholds
- Report definitions and recurring review cadence
- Phase 2 backlog and change-control process

9. Go-Live Readiness and Hypercare

A weighted readiness assessment prevents launch decisions from relying on general confidence. Each category requires explicit evidence.

Readiness area	Weight	Score	Evidence
Requirements approved	10	10	Signed requirements register
Configuration complete	15	15	Configuration review
Data validation complete	15	15	Exception report cleared
UAT exit criteria met	20	20	Test summary and defect disposition
Security approval	10	10	Role matrix approval
Training complete	10	10	Attendance and recording
Support model active	10	10	Queue and escalation test
Communications and rollback	10	10	Launch notice and go/no-go record

Simulated go decision

Proceed with the two-location pilot because there are no open critical/high defects, required approvals are complete, data exceptions are resolved, training is complete, and the remaining medium defect has an accepted workaround.

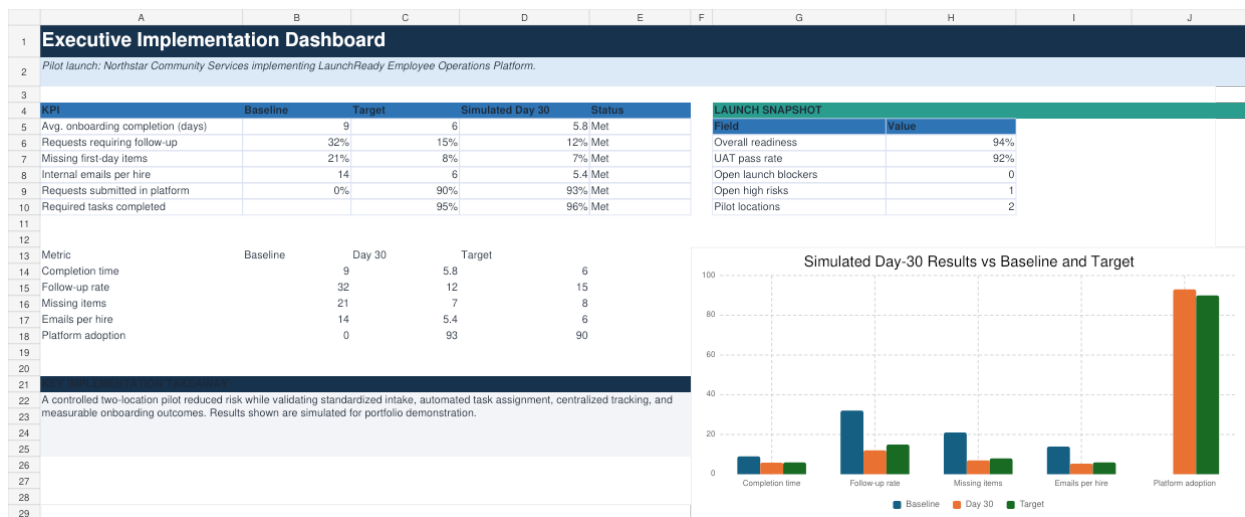
Hypercare model

- Daily triage for 10 business days.
- Critical escalation within 30 minutes.
- Adoption review every two business days.
- Central issue queue with severity, owner, due date, and resolution evidence.
- Formal closeout at the end of Day 10.

10. Post-Launch Measurement

The following results are intentionally presented as simulated Day-30 outcomes. They demonstrate how success would be measured; they are not real-world claims.

Metric	Baseline	Target	Simulated Day 30	Outcome
Completion time	9 days	6 days	5.8 days	Met
Requests requiring follow-up	32%	<15%	12%	Met
Missing first-day items	21%	<8%	7%	Met
Internal emails per hire	14	≤6	5.4	Met
Platform adoption	0%	≥90%	93%	Met
Required task completion	Not measured	≥95%	96%	Met



Executive dashboard evidence: simulated baseline, target, Day-30 metrics, readiness, and UAT status.

11. Lessons Learned and Phase 2

Lesson	Evidence	Recommendation
Begin data cleanup early	Duplicate IDs and missing manager relationships required owner decisions	Add a pre-import profiling report
Use scenario-based training	Practice reduced basic support questions	Convert training to self-paced modules
Define severity before UAT	The team could accept a medium defect consistently	Embed severity and acceptance workflow
Assign dashboard ownership	Users applied different filters	Publish standard executive and manager views
Govern mappings after launch	New roles can create checklist gaps	Add monthly configuration review

Recommended Phase 2 backlog

- Expand to the remaining six locations.
- Create self-paced manager and task-owner training.
- Integrate with the source HRIS through an API.
- Add mobile task completion.
- Explore predictive alerts for likely onboarding delays.

12. Competency Evidence

Target competency	Portfolio evidence
SaaS implementation lifecycle	End-to-end simulated discovery through post-launch review
Business analysis	Discovery findings, BRD, requirements, stories, acceptance criteria
Process mapping	Current- and future-state workflows
Project coordination	Plan, milestones, dependencies, status, and governance
Risk management	RAID and decision logs
Data validation	Mapping, intentional errors, exception handling, corrections
UAT / QA	Strategy, cases, results, defects, retest, exit criteria
Documentation	Quick guide, knowledge article, admin handoff, launch communication
Product operations	Adoption metrics, lessons learned, and Phase 2 backlog
AI-assisted productivity	AI used to structure and refine simulated artifacts; decisions remain human-reviewed

How to explain this project in an interview

30-second version

I created an independent simulated SaaS implementation for a growing multi-location organization. I translated discovery findings into requirements, designed the future-state workflow, coordinated an eight-week pilot plan, validated intentionally flawed sample data, built UAT and defect evidence, prepared training and go-live materials, and designed a 30-day measurement approach. The project gave me hands-on practice with the documentation and analytical work required in implementation and business-analysis roles.

Appendix A — Launch Communication

Subject: LaunchReady pilot begins October 22

The LaunchReady Employee Operations Platform will become the required onboarding channel for the Buffalo and Rochester pilot locations on October 22. Hiring managers should submit all new-hire requests through LaunchReady beginning on that date. Email requests will be redirected to the platform so information, tasks, ownership, and status remain in one place.

Managers must complete training before launch and review the quick-reference guide. During the first 10 business days, questions and issues should be submitted through the LaunchReady support link. Critical access issues will be escalated immediately; other requests will be prioritized during daily hypercare triage.

Thank you for supporting a consistent, visible, and measurable onboarding process.

Appendix B — Weekly Status Report

Area	Status / update
Overall	Green — pilot remains on schedule
Completed	Configuration review, data validation, UAT execution, manager training
Next	Go/no-go review, launch communication, pilot activation
Risks	Manager adoption remains under monitoring; targeted office hours scheduled
Issues	No open critical/high defects; one medium workaround accepted
Decisions needed	None
Help needed	Department leaders reinforce platform-only request intake

Appendix C — Artifact Inventory

The companion implementation workbook contains the detailed, editable evidence supporting this case study: discovery, requirements, traceability, user stories, project plan, RACI, RAID, decision log, configuration, data readiness, UAT and defects, enablement, go-live, and post-launch measurement. The companion PowerPoint presents the story in a recruiter-friendly format.